

Networking careers

Who keeps the Wi-Fi up?

College and Career Exploration · Week 3 · Day 1

Bring your notebook, a pencil, and your Chromebook. Find Your Future workbook only if you finish early (p. 38).

As you enter

If the school Wi-Fi went down right now, whose job would it be to fix it?

What do you think they would actually DO to fix it?

Say it like this

First they would check _____, because _____.

Be specific: student devices, login accounts, access points, network cables, the server. Two people share.

Today you will

- 1 Learn what a network is and meet the four careers that keep one running.
- 2 Record one technical task and one transferable skill for each.
- 3 Stop and Jot: name a skill that transfers between two careers.
- 4 Exit ticket: a Venn diagram, programming vs. networking.

Word of the day: transferable skill. A skill you can carry from one job to another.

What is a network?



Network cables in a server room (BLS video still)

A network is a group of connected computers and devices that share information and resources.

Your school Wi-Fi is a network. So is the bank app on a phone, and a text message on its way to someone.

When it works, nobody notices. When it breaks, four kinds of people get called.

The four careers

Networking Career Cards · link on the Day 1 page

Network Administrator

Keeps the network running day to day: accounts, monitoring, troubleshooting, updates.

Network Architect

Plans and designs the network: equipment, capacity, security, cost tradeoffs.

Database Administrator

Organizes, protects, and backs up data so users get reliable answers.

Systems Analyst

Studies how an organization works and recommends technology changes; translates between tech and non-tech teams.

Network and Computer Systems Administrators PRINTER FRIENDLY

Summary

What They Do

Work Environment

How to Become One

Pay

Job Outlook

State & Area Data

Similar Occupations

More Info

Summary

Quick Facts: Network and Computer Systems Administrators	
2025 Median Pay	\$99,130 per year \$47.66 per hour
Typical Entry-Level Education	Bachelor's degree
Work Experience in a Related Occupation	None
On-the-job Training	None
Number of Jobs, 2025	323,600
Job Outlook, 2025–35	-4% (Decline)
Employment Change, 2025–35	-13,200

From the BLS Occupational Outlook Handbook.

Who gets called?

30 seconds with a partner · Voice 1

The Wi-Fi is down Monday morning. Which of the four gets called first? Which one designed the network in the first place? Which one would notice if student data went missing?

Say it like this

The _____ gets called first because their job is to _____.

Two pairs share. Then open the cards.

Compare the four roles

22 minutes · Voice 0 · Card set or notebook entry labeled 1SW Wk3 Networking

Task

One technical task this person does. Copy a verb from the card: monitor, back up, design, interview.

Skill

One transferable skill this person needs, and why it matters in this job.

Four rows: Network Administrator, Network Architect, Database Administrator, Systems Analyst.

Skills to pick from

problem-solving
communication
attention to detail
time management
teamwork
curiosity
patience under pressure

Finished early? Find Your Future p. 38: open Hats & Ladders, Clusters, Information Technology, and do the App Exploration checklist.

What transfers?

A transferable skill moves with you from job to job

Technical skill

Belongs to one job.

Configure a router. Restore a database backup. Write a network diagram.

Transferable skill

Goes with you anywhere.

Explain a problem to someone who is not technical. Notice the small detail that breaks everything. Stay calm when the system is down.

A technical skill gets you one job. A transferable skill goes with you to the next one.

Stop and Jot

60 seconds · Voice 0 · In your notebook

**Pick a skill from your rows that TWO of the four careers need.
Write one complete sentence.**

Say it like this

_____ transfers across _____ and _____
because both workers must _____.

Words you will need

problem-solving · communication · attention to detail · time management · teamwork ·
curiosity · patience under pressure

Exit ticket: programming vs. networking

Open the Day 1 exit ticket on the Canvas page · 8 minutes

Pick one programming career from Week 2 (Software Dev, Web Dev, App Dev, or Game Dev).

Pick one networking career from today.

Left: 2 skills only the programmer uses.

Right: 2 skills only the networking career uses.

Middle: 2 skills BOTH need (soft skills, not technical).

Bottom line: why do employers care about the middle as much as the technical sides? One sentence.



Open the Day 1 exit ticket

The button opens your own copy of the Venn diagram.

Say it like this

Employers care about _____ because _____.

Before you go

- 1 Four rows done: a task and a skill for each career.
- 2 Your Stop and Jot sentence in your notebook.
- 3 Exit ticket submitted.

Tomorrow: you become a UX designer and audit a real website. Bring your Find Your Future workbook.